

whatweretheythinking.com

www.fuzzybumblebee.com

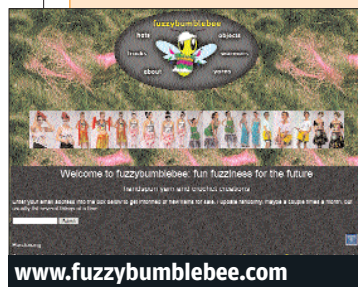
We've seen some bad sites but this one takes your breath away. The natural exclamation you let out as soon as the homepage opens is "What the..." . Beyond that, you sort of go numb—in the head, that is.

Here are the facts: Fuzzybumblebee.com claims to be a site for "handspun yarn and crochet creations." While their products would certainly have some takers, we were not impressed. They sell hats, frocks, warmers and even something called 'objects'—just one look will transport you to the house of the wicked witch in Hansel and Gretel. Jeepers Creepers!

Apparently, some of the vivid creations, such as 'lulupony hats',

'angoraparrot warmers' and 'blood-shotbash yarn' have actually been sold! Unfortunately, in this space, we can comment on the site alone and not the products (which could well warrant a few pages).

As far as the layout goes, there's none, and despite great temptation to thrash the photography and the other related technical aspects, we shall refrain. The only well-done piece is the navigation oval, which



contains a drawing of a humungous fuzzy bee (hence the name!) surrounded by links. The bee is dressed up in crocheted fur, and appears in a fresh ensemble every time you open a new link. Aha!

There are pictures of real models with bohemian (read ghastly) make-up wearing the outrageous products. A quick glance to either the left or the right will show you the background, and while it's just yarn, you could be easily fooled into thinking it was human hair adorned with bits of skinny chicken legs. Stay far away!

pundits. One reason for this was probably the timing when many other companies were shutting down their signature stores to cut costs. Obviously the idea has succeeded and Apple's stores are now wildly successful.

Microsoft had also tried this once in 1999 but their venture lasted only three years (in San Francisco) and one thought this was one idea that was shelved for good. Apparently not. Microsoft, in its continuing attempt to appear like they are copying Apple, is trying their hand at retail stores again.

Recent reports suggest that Microsoft has been in contact with New York real estate brokers who work with Times Square transactions in the past few weeks. It's not just Times Square they are after, but the most famed of all Times Square buildings, One Times Square, otherwise known as "News Years Eve Big-A** Ball-Dropping Zone".

It is important to

understand the reasons for Apple's success before we delve into why MS would fail. It comes from their small market share and relatively small target market, not to mention the iPod. Apple sells sleek, sexy hardware and Microsoft sells boxed software and a minuscule amount of hardware.

So while there is no shortage of reasons to browse in an Apple Store, one has to wonder if there are compelling enough, if any, reasons to visit a Microsoft retail store. The answer isn't so obvious and Microsoft is likely to have its hands full as it attempts to create a successful retail presence.

But, with its mountains of money and a major OS release scheduled for late 2006, opening a store in one of the most highly trafficked areas of New York might be worth a gamble. We'll see! ■

Compiled by Aditya Kuber,
Ishan Prakash, Ram Mohan Rao
and Renuka Rane

Blog WATCH

Imagine capitalising on the likeness between the date 31 Aug and the word 'blog' itself! Also read about what comprises God, surveillance technology and popular blog carnivals in the virtual world

The 3rd World View

<http://rezwanul.blogspot.com/2005/08/blog-day-2005-bash-nir-ofir-israeli.html>

Nir Ofir, an Israeli blogger first noticed that the date 3108 (August 31st) looks like the word "Blog". He started to promote an idea based on this.

David Sasaki of 'Global Voices Online' writes about Nir's idea:

He had also become increasingly aware that as more weblogs from around the world make their way onto the internet, the more we get stuck in our regular reading habits without searching for new content and new voices from other cultures and viewpoints. Despite the rhetoric of the internet making the world a smaller place, most weblogs still link to bloggers from their same country and with their same political outlook.

Fafblog

<http://fafblog.blogspot.com/2005/08/creation-science-creation-technology.html>

Creation Science, Creation Technology!

Yknow we been hearin a lot lately about how Intelligent Design's not real science. Well that's just crazy talk! Ever since we got scientific evidence of the existence of God everybody down at the Fafblog has been buildin off this cuttin edge field to come up with latest scientologial developments.

Physics

By observing the mating of Galapagos finches with

high-precision godometers, designmatologists have discovered the existence of the Godtrino-the subatomic particle that God is made of! Theoretical Godmologists have believed that evolution was caused by the presence of Godtrinos for years but this is our first concrete proof. And think of the practical applications once we manage to harness the power of mass Godtrino production! Turnin water into wine, smiting, more smiting, Gomorrorah burning, Jesus resuscitation. The possibilities are endless!

Junto Boyz

<http://bernardmoon.blogspot.com>

More On MS... Waking Up The Sleeping Giant

I've been meaning to post Brad Feld's thoughts on how 2006 will be Microsoft's year, but it's good that I was busy with other stuff and forgot to do so. Brad's post: *I'm often wrong (but never in doubt) and—after spending the day at PDC and an evening with a number of the project leads for various Vista technologies—it feels like 2006 is going to be Microsoft's year. Microsoft has been kicked around plenty the last few years by the likes of Google, Yahoo, the press, and many participants in the software industry. During this time, the Microsoft money machine has continued to generate cash at a prodigious rate. The home of "build it cheap and stack it high" is about to have two major project releases relevant to over 500 million computers...*